



State Employment
Leadership Network

Monthly Network Meeting
March 21, 2018

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SELN Monthly Network Meeting: March 21, 2018

AGENDA

Welcome to everyone!

- Brief intros
- Housekeeping

Project Business

- Employment Consultants. Their role, a model of supports, and measuring implementation
Allison Hall, University of Massachusetts Boston
Alberto Migliore, University of Massachusetts Boston
Kelly Nye-Lengerman, University of Minnesota
- Upcoming Network meetings (60 minutes, all 3pm ET)
 - April 18th
 - May 16th
 - June 20th

Stay up to date and in the loop: www.selnhub.org



Employment Consultants.
Their role, a model of supports, and
measuring implementation.

University of Massachusetts Boston
University of Minnesota

SELN network meeting
March 21, 2018

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Advancing employment and opportunity for people with intellectual and developmental disabilities

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Today’s Discussion

- ❖ The role of employment consultants.
- ❖ A model of employment supports.
- ❖ Measuring implementation.
- ❖ Your thoughts.
- ❖ Q&A.

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RRTC on Advancing
Employment for
Individuals with IDD



- ❑ Individual and family knowledge & engagement
- ❑ **Effective employment supports**
- ❑ Organizational change for community rehabilitation providers
- ❑ State-level policy and strategy

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What is an Employment Consultant ?

- ❖ A professional who assist job seekers with disabilities explore, find, and secure employment.
- ❖ Other common titles:
 - Job Developer
 - Employment Specialist
 - Employment Navigator
 - Business Consultant
 - And MORE!

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Why are employment consultants important?

“... Regardless of the job seeker’s level of motivation, skill, experience, attitude, and support system, his or her ability to get a job will often depend on the effectiveness of employment specialists. Simply stated, if they are good, job seekers get jobs. If they are not, the barriers to employment for job seekers can become insurmountable...”

Luecking, R. G., Fabian, E. S., & Tilson, C. P. (2004). Working relationships: Creating career opportunities for job seekers with disabilities through employer partnerships. Baltimore: Paul H. Brookes, p. 29



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A model of employment support

- ❖ Findings from interviews with 16 employment consultants, their supervisors, job seekers, & family members.
- ❖ What strategies do effective employment consultants use?

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Comprehensive Model of Employment Support



For more visit: www.thinkwork.org/rtc

Direct contact: alberto.migliore@umb.edu

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Quotes from the field

“...I've got to establish some ground rules from the beginning: number one ground rule is ‘I'm not here to find you a job. You and I together as a team are going to find a job’...”



Building trust

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Quotes from the field



“... So always listen to the individual first and make sure that their voice is heard because it's very easy for that voice to get lost amongst agencies, the family, the state, the employer, if they're employed, other various community members and team members... Their voice needs to be weighed more than any other.”

Getting to know a job seeker

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Quotes from the field



".... we've done a better job at matching people in their jobs, now the job coach's role has really shifted to sort of connecting the person directly with the employer... they're there to make connections so that they can back out of the job pretty quickly..."

Supports after hire

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BRINGING EMPLOYMENT FIRST TO SCALE

Assisting Job Seekers with Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities: A Guide for Employment Consultants

GUIDE NO. 1.0 (2017)

Key Findings from the HRTIC on Advancing Employment

[...]

Table 3. Guide for implementing key support activities

	Low priority	Medium priority	High priority	Not applicable
Building trust				
1. I meet the job seeker with respect (e.g., by establishing eye contact, speaking directly to him or her, not through someone else, using my ordinary tone of voice).				
2. I prioritize the job seeker's personal aspirations over other players' demands.				
3. I involve the job seeker in all major decisions including choosing what strategies to use to find jobs.				

To find out more, [visit Thinkwork.org](http://www.thinkwork.org)

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What matters most?

- ❖ Build **trust** with the job seeker and their family
- ❖ Find out what **the job seeker wants** out of life and seek out employment that fits their vision for themselves
- ❖ Make decisions about your support strategies based on the JSs' **individual preferences** and support needs
- ❖ **Be creative** in your job search. Look for tasks, not jobs
- ❖ **Network** with employers and community business partners
- ❖ **Involve the job seeker** in every step of the process and maintain contact after hire

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Measuring implementation.

"If you don't know where you are going, you'll end up somewhere else"
Yogi Berra

"Without data, you are just another person with an opinion"
Sir Ken Robinson

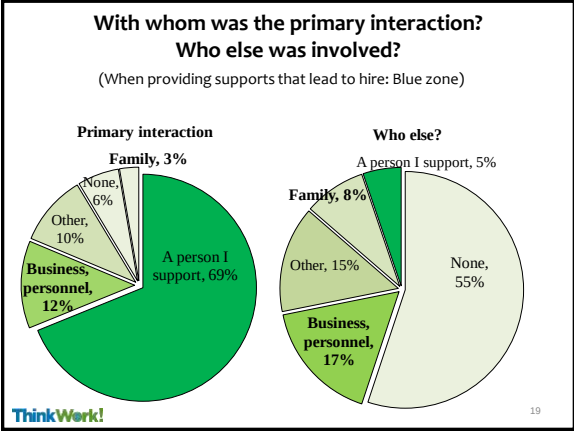
"A first step toward effectiveness is to record actual time use..." Peter Drucker

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Network meeting updates and info: <http://www.selnhub.org/groups/home/39>

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We love to hear from you!

- How often does your program use data to promote the implementation of effective supports?
- What data tracking tools does your program use?
- How is the funding structure promoting the implementation of effective support practices?

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Questions?

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